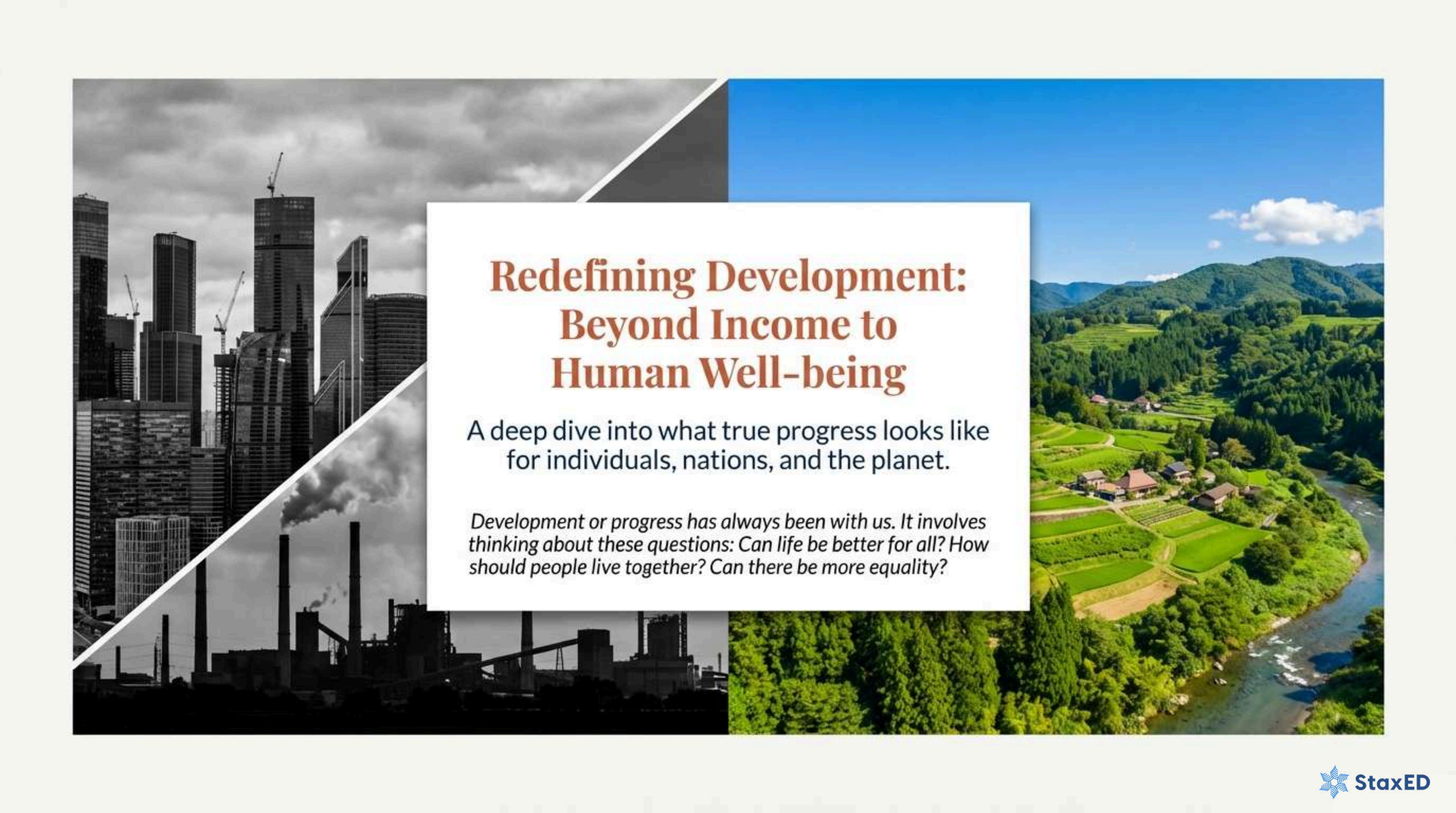




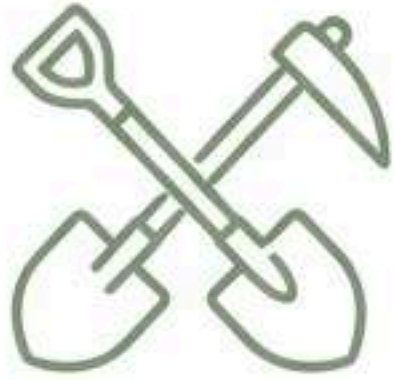
Redefining Development: Beyond Income to Human Well-being

A deep dive into what true progress looks like
for individuals, nations, and the planet.

*Development or progress has always been with us. It involves
thinking about these questions: Can life be better for all? How
should people live together? Can there be more equality?*

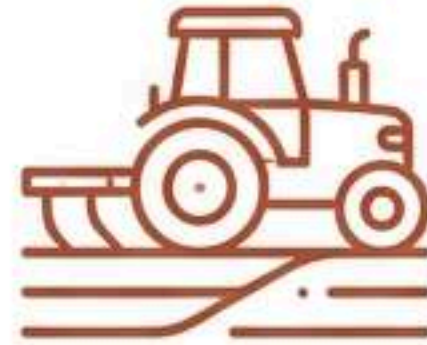
Different People, Different Goals

Developmental aspirations are often conflicting.



Landless Rural Labourer

- More **days of work** and **better wages**.
- Local school able to provide quality education for children.
- No social discrimination.



Prosperous Farmer (Punjab)

- High family income through **higher support prices**.
- Hardworking and cheap labour.
- Ability to **settle children abroad**.



Girl from Rich Urban Family

- Freedom equal to her brother.
- Ability to **decide her own life path**.
- Pursue **studies abroad**.

When Development Becomes Destruction



“What may be development for one may not be development for the other. It may even be destructive for the other.”

The Conflict

Industrialists: Want more dams to generate electricity.

vs.

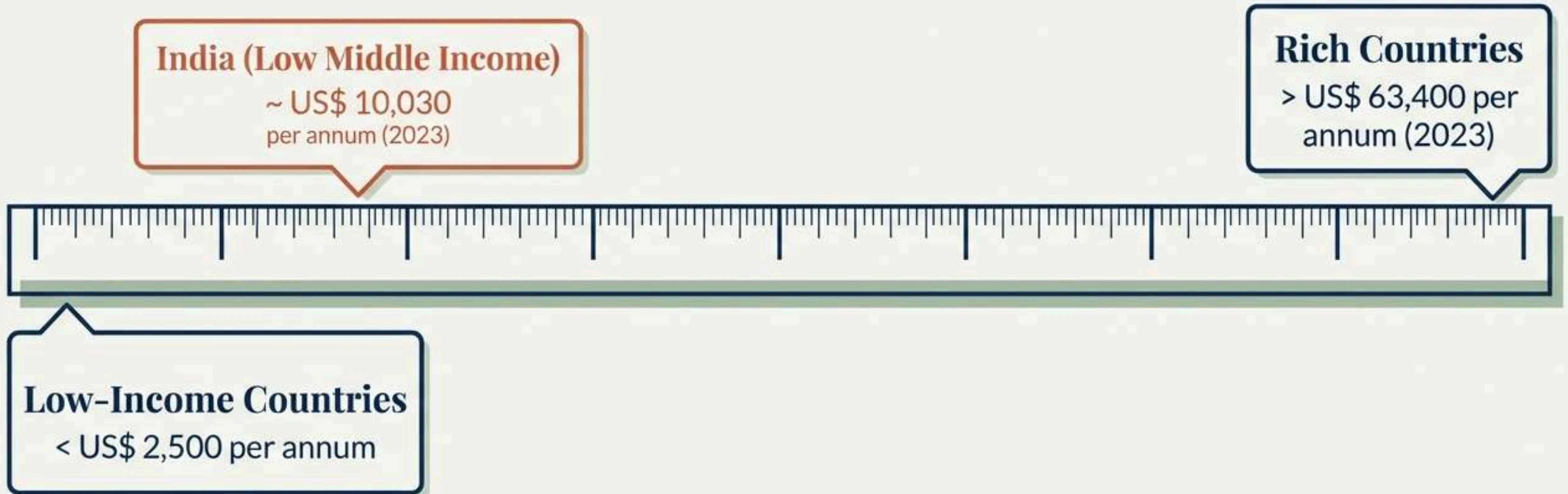
Tribals & Displaced Groups: Face submerged land and disrupted lives. They prefer small check dams or tanks.

Income is Not the Only Goal



Money, or material things that one can buy with it, is one factor on which our life depends. But the quality of our life also depends on non-material things.

The World Bank's Yardstick



Metric: Average Income (Per Capita Income) = Total Income of Country ÷ Total Population.

The Trap of Averages

Average income is useful for comparison but it does not tell us how this income is distributed.

Country A (Equitable Distribution)



Average Income: ~10,000 | **Reality:**
No Rich, No Poor

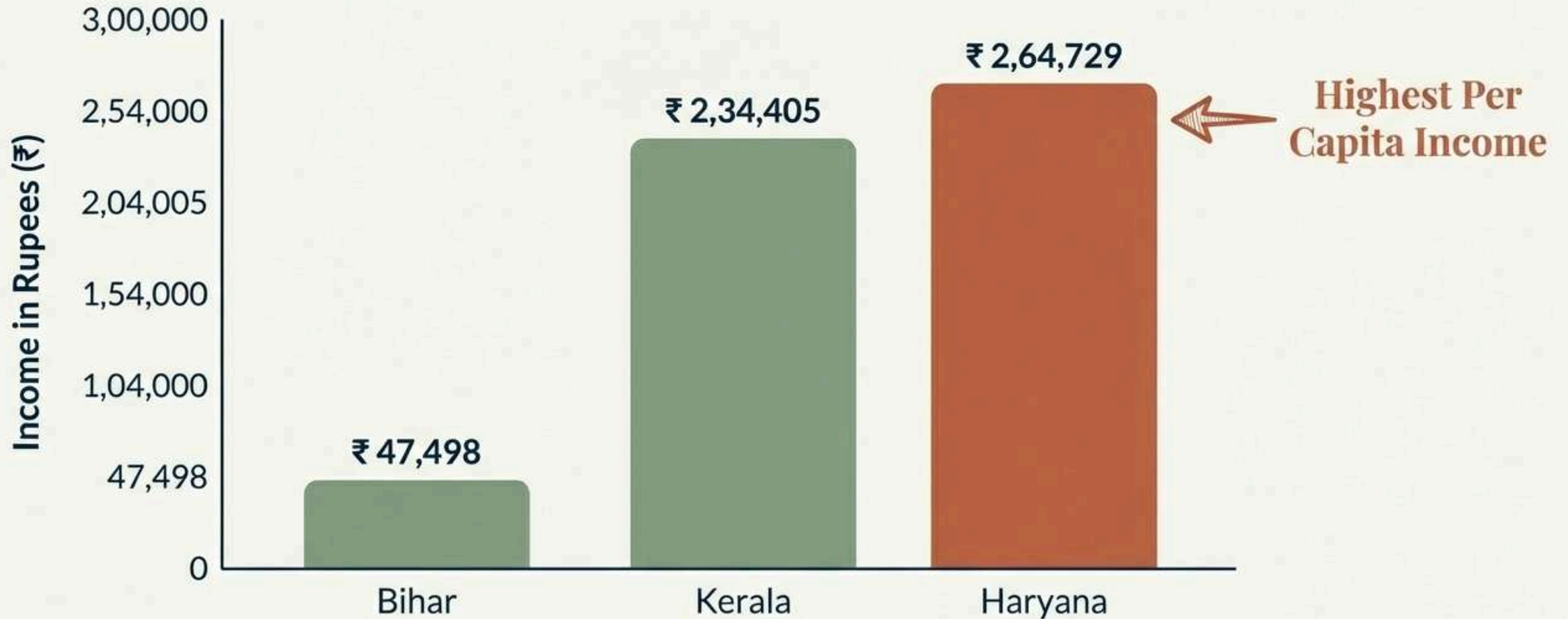
Country B (High Inequality)



Average Income: ~10,000 | **Reality:**
Extreme Poverty & Extreme Wealth

The Income Illusion

Per Capita Income (2021-22)



Source: Economic Survey 2023-24

Money Cannot Buy Pollution-Free Environments

The Reality Check: Social Indicators

	Haryana	Kerala
Infant Mortality Rate (per 1,000 births)	28 	6 
Literacy Rate (2017-18)	82%	94%
Net Attendance Ratio (Secondary)	61	83

Despite lower income, Kerala has better human outcomes because of adequate public facilities.

The Power of Public Facilities



Why Collective Provision?

It is cheaper and more effective to provide goods collectively than individually.



Security: Collective security for the locality vs. guards for every house.



Education: Schools exist because the government provides them and other children want to study.



Health: Prevention of infectious diseases requires community steps.

The Human Development Index (HDI)

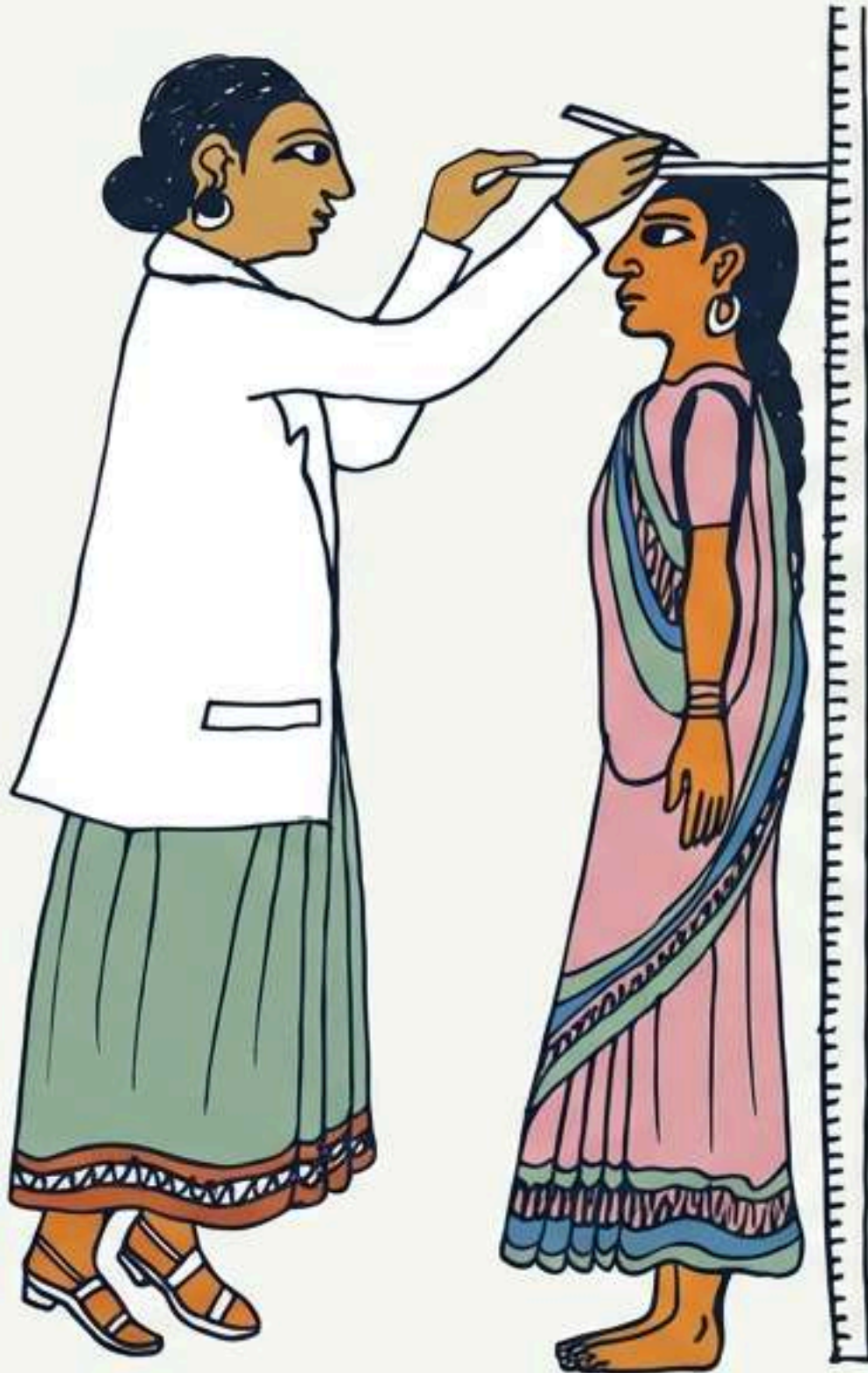
Health + Education + Standard of Living

Country	HDI Rank	Life Expectancy	Mean Years of Schooling	GNI Per Capita
Sri Lanka	78	76.6	11.2	11,899
India	134	67.7	6.5	6,951

“

A small country in our neighbourhood, Sri Lanka, is much ahead of India in every respect.

Measuring Nutritional Access



Body Mass Index (BMI)

Formula: $\text{Weight (kg)} \div \text{Height}^2 \text{ (m)}$

The Nutritional Gap:

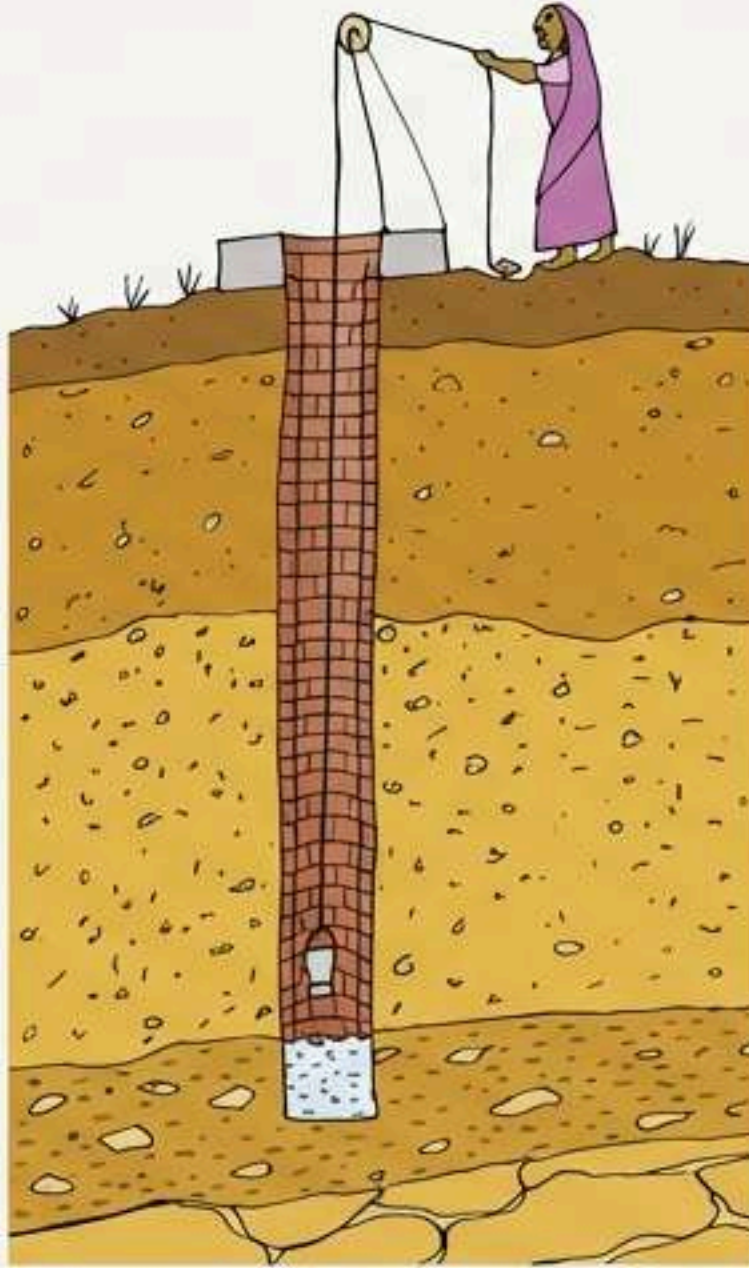
- National Average: ~20% of men and 23% of women are undernourished (BMI < 18.5).
- Madhya Pradesh: 28% of males are undernourished.

There is a gap between 'enough food in the country' and the nutritional status of the people.

The Crisis of Renewable Resources

Sustainability Example: Groundwater

Overuse: 1/3rd of the country is overusing groundwater reserves.



Decline: 300 districts reported water level decline of >4 metres in 20 years.

Hotspots: Punjab, Western U.P., and hard rock plateau areas.

Even renewable resources can be exhausted if usage exceeds replenishment.

The Exhaustion of Non-Renewables

Sustainability Example: Crude Oil

Global Crude Oil Reserves

Estimated to last only ~50 years at current extraction rates.

The Geopolitical Risk:

- **India:** Dependent on imports; vulnerable to price hikes.
- **USA:** Secures reserves through military and economic power.

We have a **fixed stock** on earth which **cannot be replenished**.



We Have Borrowed the World

“We have not inherited the world from our forefathers — we have borrowed it from our children.”

Sustainable Development: Development without overuse. A new area of knowledge where scientists, economists, and philosophers work together.



The Perennial Question



Development Checklist

- ✓ Is it a mix of goals? (Income + Freedom)
- ✓ Is it distributed equitably? (Beyond Averages)
- ✓ Are public facilities provided? (Health + Education)
- ✓ Is it sustainable? (Future-proof)

National development means asking: Would the idea benefit a large number of people or only a small group?